

RAJESH DAMMALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud operations leader with 16+ years driving reliability engineering, incident management, and service delivery excellence across globally distributed teams. Proven track record building Tier 3 support into a world-class reliability function — reducing systemic risk, eliminating recurring issues, and driving measurable customer outcomes at scale. Deep expertise in Azure, AWS, VMware environments with hands-on automation, observability, and operational readiness capabilities. Passionate about transforming reactive support into proactive operational engineering that delivers exceptional customer experience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Tier 3 Reliability Engineering • High-Severity Incident Response • Problem Management & RCA • Escalation Management • Global Team Leadership (32+ engineers) • Operational Excellence & KPIs • Cloud Operations (Azure/AWS/GCP) • Automation & Observability • Customer Experience Strategy • ITIL Framework & Best Practices • Cross-Functional Partnerships • Nearshore/Offshore Delivery Models

SELECTED IMPACT

- %, Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% across 20+ mission-critical production services
- %, Reduced issue resolution time by 32% through escalation framework redesign and systemic problem elimination
- %, Eliminated 25,000+ false/stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts — reducing noise and systemic risk
- %, Architected AI-driven incident automation platform achieving 30-35% automated resolution rate
- %, Authored 175+ troubleshooting guides establishing Tier 3 engineering standards for diagnostics and root cause isolation
- %, Maintained 100% SLA compliance across globally distributed 24/7/365 support operations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE | May 2021 – Present

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) — Redmond, WA

- Run Tier 3 support as a reliability engineering function — own high-severity incident response, operational excellence, and systemic risk reduction across 20+ cloud services
- Own Problem Management lifecycle: root cause analysis, corrective actions, recurring issue elimination, and continuous service hardening
- Established engineering standards for diagnostics, telemetry, and operational readiness — authored 175+ playbooks in 5 months
- Built measurable reliability practices with targeted KPIs; drove automation that uplifted Tier 1/2 support organizations
- Partner with Engineering and Security teams to resolve platform defects, improve observability, and strengthen operational resiliency
- Defined and monitor operational quality metrics identifying systemic issues, operational gaps, and emerging risks
- Drive executive strategy for customer experience, operational performance, and service delivery quality
- Lead globally distributed teams with 24/7/365 on-call coverage and cross-functional incident coordination

Azure Support Technical Lead — Customer Support Services | Nov 2016 – May 2021

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Redmond, WA

- Led team of 15 engineers driving customer support initiatives across Azure enterprise environments
- Managed escalation management and incident response with relentless urgency and accountability
- Drove customer satisfaction and service reliability metrics across enterprise cloud operations
- Spearheaded cross-functional collaboration integrating support with engineering and product teams
- Scaled customer operations to support business growth across Azure platform services

Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Operations | May 2012 – Nov 2016

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) — Hyderabad, India | Redmond, WA

- Led globally distributed team of 32 engineers (onshore/offshore model) for Azure infrastructure reliability
- Built and executed operational strategies improving platform reliability, scalability, and customer experience
- Developed PowerShell automation saving thousands of manual operational hours annually
- Owned incident management and change management across cluster-to-blade infrastructure operations
- Created 200+ platform improvements during ICM, JIT, Azure KeyVault, and monitoring onboarding

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) — Hammond, IN

- Infrastructure operations: server builds, decommissions, data center engineering, large-scale data migrations
- Applied patches, hotfixes, and service packs across enterprise environments; configured server clusters

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Azure (AppInsights, Logic Apps, KeyVault, AD), AWS, GCP, VMware

Automation & IaC: PowerShell, Python, Terraform, Azure Logic Apps, AIOps

Monitoring & Observability: Kusto/KQL, Power BI, ICM, Grafana, Azure Monitor, ServiceNow

Identity & Security: Entra ID (Azure AD), MFA, Conditional Access, SIEM integration

DevOps: ADO Pipelines, Git, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code

Frameworks: ITIL, Incident/Problem/Change Management, SLAs/SLOs/SLIs